

Title: I see a lot of posts here asking about some basics to Wave Management or basic Laning Tips.

Here are some basic thought processes and patterns I consider/notice as a high Diamond player.

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

Understanding the basics I'd say is super important at low elo, basics being:

* **You have to be able to identify which way a wave will move if untouched and understand Freezing**

* Most of you know this, so I'll make it short. Two main factors: quantity of minions and line of scrimmage for minions. More minions on one side = advantage, pushing. Line of scrimmage closer to one side = over time, the team closer to their tower will get reinforcements faster and therefore establish slight advantage/push if team sizes are equal. These two factors can be equal/close to equal, which is very helpful for Freezing.

* Freezing is holding a line of scrimmage somewhere between the middle of the lane and your turret, whilst having MORE minions on the enemy team to offset the reinforcement timing delta. Freezing is helpful for many reasons including:

- * Resilience to jungler ganks

- * Ability to zone enemy if you are strong enough (keep them out of CS/XP range)

* If you can hold a freeze during the time that an enemy resets or is dead, this is instant lane over. You will/can become strong enough off that to be able to draw proxy pressure later. The reason is that your incoming stacked wave will kill your team wave very quickly, and you can sometimes get the incoming minions to wipe out 2 full friendly waves during the duration of a reset. Think of it like denial in DOTA.

- * Freezing likely ends up with one of three outcomes at low elo/while learning

- * You fail to "trim" (kill off) some of the incoming minions, and enemy uses their waveclear abilities to crash the wave into your turret. Your wave will then inevitably "bounce" into them unless

there are so few that they die to your turret before your reinforcements arrive.

- * You trim well, but a tiny bit too much with too few minions remaining or can't hold them due to enemy trade threat, this results in your tower/abilities wiping them out before your reinforcements arrive, and the next wave will simply be neutral.

- * You trim too much, leading to the lane "mini bouncing" into a slow push as your wave is slightly weakened by the 1-2 remaining minions and then arriving on your side of neutral as a slightly weakened and pushing line of scrimmage position.

* **Tips and Tricks to manage waves better**

- * In either of these situations, you can often "buffer" (wait for NEXT reinforcements to arrive first) before clearing the enemy wave to go for a crash. Failing to buffer will lead to you not quite crashing and the enemy getting to freeze on you. Failing to have the ability to contest the "hold" (enemy standing tanking minions until their arrive" or "drag" (enemy pulling minions to the side/into a bush) means they will get a freeze on you.

- * Look at where your own approaching reinforcement waves are before attempting to clear/crash. If the reinforcements are super close, they will hold your potential crash at a super inconvenient position right outside of the enemy turret range.

- * It CAN BE very dangerous to do the final push on a crash, because you often use your ability CDs on the wave to shove it, and the final line of scrimmage before the crash is often closer to the enemy turret, meaning they can all-in you or their jungler can come from behind. Best option here unless you're super slippery is to just fight in your big stacked wave.

- * In general, you do not want to push the first few waves with more than a 1 minion advantage. The reason is that, for instance, if you create a 3 minion delta, your wave will shove into their Freeze zone too quickly. If they trim perfectly, they can hold this position as long as they want. Some players will even bait AoE abilities like Ahri Q or Brand W in their wave just to set this situation up for their jungler to level 2/3 gank. If you push with a 1 minion delta then the line of scrimmage will only move slightly while guaranteeing you the level up timing advantage. In certain matchups where you

have resourceless waveclear and advantage level 1 (akali into Zed), you can successfully shove 2nd wave under turret before Zed gets level 2, this is good. It makes it so that his wave bounces to you and you'll be in a safe lane state for levels 3-4 if you want.

- * There are certain "trims" that people will do, such as only taking the melees or only taking the cannon using dematerializer, or only taking mage minions/2 mage minions etc. I honestly don't fully understand the outcome of these so I'm hoping someone can elaborate on this below.

- * There are some fancy shenanigans some high Diamond+ players will do, where they willingly trade their HP by pulling minion aggro during a trade (used to be more common with corrupting pot users I think), because it makes their wave push (LB minions still attacking wave, enemy minions attacking LB) while getting a nice trade in. Depending on how much a player is planning ahead, something like a corrupting pot leblanc into a weak laner might do this to move the line of scrimmage ever so slightly towards enemy, forcing their wave to slow push back to Leblanc, allowing her to take lots of favorable trades while enemy last hits, ultimately out-sustaining and zoning them because of corrupting pot by level 4-6.

- * **Can I leave lane when they have the ability to shove a crash? No. This is called them having Prio.**

- * You can't just leave lane willy nilly whether you're support, top, or mid. You lost that dragon or scuttle contest or gank opportunity when you let them enemy crash into your tower at a crucial time, your previous failure to manage waves should not be added onto with more failure by abandoning lane at poor times. This can suck for junglers that have lanes with no prio. This can suck for ADCs with a slow pushing waviestate and a pyke support randomly roaming mid. This can suck for contesting drag 4v4 while two waves die to your turret. This can suck for lots of reasons.

- * **Then when can I leave lane?** You can leave under the following conditions:

- * You are bad and lost too many trades or traded too much HP for CS, your jungler is not bailing you out with a helpful reset shove, you are just waiting to be all-inned or dove. Leave. Living and coming back with some semblance of tempo (you'll arrive back with spent gold before enemy does,

even though they'll likely have more gold) is your best bet.

* Mutual resets (if enemy clears a wave and hits B or hits B before waves meet in empty lane, you should do the same). Exception: you can crash incoming wave with fast clear and have teleport while they don't, or if incoming wave is not a cannon wave and you aren't afraid of 1v1 with jungler. If Enemy makes it back and you haven't reset quickly enough to catch your wave under tower, it will be a big disadvantage.

* Forced mutual reset with tempo (blow CDs/Mana to instaclear a cannon wave then back, even if you don't finish off cannon). When you feel like the enemy just shoved you under turret and there is nothing you can do about it but clear while they reset, they just did this to you. This is super helpful when you hit a nice item spike, especially if you're winning in CS (they won't be able to afford their spike). The counter to this is trimming incoming potential crashes and managing your resources (don't blow Ahri Qs on trading without hitting minions if you're playing vs a cass TF etc with great shove).

* You crashed a wave and now have a Roam Timer. You have X Seconds to do whatever. STRICTLY X SECONDS. You can use this for whatever you want, just use it for something. Better players will use it better. Ward their chickens, ward a pixel or side bush, go out of vision to make their side lanes freak out, help your jungler invade, roam bot into a reset teleport back, whatever. Just be back in your lane before it gets crashed into your turret. X seconds are based on the amount of minions crashed and your enemy's waveclear/ability to shove.

* Post-kill at a good wave state (wave pushing to you or crashed after kill). Sometimes a jungler can come and drag wave or clear it, which can nullify this advantage.

****Why does Wave Management matter to a jungler?****

* Dive opportunities can single handedly win a lane, and I don't mean "hur dur we dove them and killed them +1 kill yay". I mean, even if your support Leo dies to their Kaisa while diving Kaisa

Braum, it can be 100% worth it if it means their Kaisa is missing 2-3 waves of XP and gold. Always look for your lanes to be stacking crashes and help them walk it in. Most of the time their bot will not recognize this threat. Deny their carries as much gold and XP as possible is the whole theme here.

* If the enemy laner is walking in a 2+ wave crash, then Gank theory suggests that you better have 95%+ chances of success to bother ganking a lane while your laner is freezing or getting crashed on. They can stay in their mega wave and 1v2 you, depending on HP %/Champs involved. Game experience and outcome prediction separate great players from others here, assuming they're considering this to begin with. Not only this, but even if you do kill them 3/4 of the way back to their turret, your laner has likely now lost multiple minions to their turret and will have to fix wave before backing (hint, you need to help fix it quickly).

* Conversely, if the enemy is walking in a crash and you think about this from a defensive perspective instead of an offensive one, you should be considering if the enemy will come to dive your laner with that crash. You should hover their lane if possible or at least ward/check the path to them on your path.

* Your ganks, even when successful, can absolutely dick over your laner's Prio and Tempo. Example: in the above situation where your top has a wave crashing his turret whilst you gank, he now has to clear this whole wave, at minimum before backing. That assumes he understands that much.

* Worst case? He clears it, then starts to push next wave solo, only to die to fresh tempo enemy top laner before your top can crash it (happens LITERALLY ALL THE TIME).

* Second likely outcome? He clears just the crashed wave, then resets. By the time he gets back, his wave has now slow pushed into the enemy and he has lost 1.5 waves of XP, is now down in XP and gold, and is getting frozen on. From here he either gets fucked the rest of lane because of your "good gank" or you come help him again to shove and bounce.

* Third, least likely outcome in low elo? You shove HARD with NO breaks in autoing wave even if it means you miss CS until that wave crashes enemy turret before leaving. He will spam ping

question marks and complain about tax. It's for his benefit.

* Identifying when your laners are down tempo and being frozen on means they require a "jungler bailout". It happens, some people are worse than enemy laners at their same elo, sometimes matchups are hard, but either way they are being zoned and frozen on. It is your duty as jungler to help them shove to tower (WITHOUT taking CS if possible) and letting them reset with tempo.

* If one of your laners dies for any reason, whether solo or to their jungler, assume the enemy team "fixes wave" prior to reset. They require a "jungler cover". Either your tower is getting crashed (go soak it up, baby!) or your lane is slow pushing towards them (go crash that shit). If you are low, don't want to show, or their spooky laner stayed for a plate, there are certain situations where you should still play around this, such as taking chickens in mid lane XP range or even pinging a global ult (shen) while going for a flank on the greedy plate taker.

* Paying attention to wave prio matters at a high elo to determine where you can and cannot show yourself. If herald is up, your top side jungle is up, and your top laner and mid are getting dicked with no idea where the enemy jungle is, showing yourself for any play <95% success rate bot is absurd. Exceptions always exist, right, like 300 adoration stack draven on your team freezing against a super overextended and low HP target while your sup naut has flash and ult and their adc flash is down, but the fact is that even in that scenario a good enemy jungle will punish you hard for that and taking drag after that play could be risky if their mid is able to hard harass you on drag after shoving your mid in (from outside your hard engage range). Very likely outcome of you losing your topside, herald, dying at drag to their mid, and your ADC coming back to an enemy that just crashed wave and reset (maybe now having equal spent gold and XP to your draven).

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 113]

why the downvotes, this took a bunch of time and should be helpful to someone :3

[Comment 2 | Score: 13]

Good stuff but I won't lie you referenced a dota tactic and I (among others I assume) have never touched Dota so we can't relate to it. Is there a more relatable example you can think of?

[Comment 3 | Score: 5]

Dang I didn't know we got wave management down to a science

[Comment 4 | Score: 2]

Thanks for the thorough post!

[Comment 5 | Score: 1]

Well written and useful !